

early age, all three boys had to earn what they got. How well I remember the constant refrain, “Idle hands are the tools of the devil” (pronounced, in the Scots way, *divil*).

I’ve often thought that we three brothers had the perfect growing-up environment: a family with community standing and never a concern about being inferior or dis-respected, yet with the need to take responsibility for our own spending money (and even to help fund the family exchequer), the initiative to get jobs, and the discipline of working for others. While we had wonderful friends—still friends today—who had more than enough and who played while we worked, we learned early on the joy of accepting responsibility, of using our wits, and of engagement with the people (rich and far from rich alike) whom we served in our various jobs, winter, summer, spring, and fall.

Blair Academy: “Come, Study, Learn”

In seventh and eighth grades, we twins attended a small grammar school in Spring Lake, New Jersey; we then moved on to nearby Manasquan High School. But my mother, ambitious for her sons and deeply concerned that we weren’t getting the best of schooling, sought something much better. Through her persistence and determination, all three Bogle boys became boarding students at Blair Academy in northwestern New Jersey—an incredible opportunity to begin a fine education. It was my mother’s drive for her boys’ education that overcame our lack of money, and Blair provided us with scholarships and jobs. In my first year, I waited on tables and, as a senior, rose to the demanding job of captain of the waiters.

Blair’s motto (translated from the Latin) is “Come, Study, Learn,” and so I did. Pushed by demanding old-school masters who seemed to sense that I could, with great effort, excel—although the classwork was far more demanding than any I’d ever before encountered—I gradually managed to overcome my early lag in studies. At graduation, I was class salutatorian, and was voted “Best Student”